

The sentence

the cat sat on the mat



count, and forget the order

The vector

1	1	1	1	2
cat	mat	on	sat	the

shape (5,) – one slot per vocabulary word, and this vocabulary has 5.

Reverse it and you cannot: cat×1 mat×1 on×1 sat×1 the×2 ... has no order left in it.

"the cat sat on the mat" and "the mat sat on the cat" give the identical vector. That is the whole limitation, in one line.